

Element A

Presentation and Justification of the Problem



This problem involves two rabbits living at the Wildlife Center in Piedmont, and the staff members who are responsible for caring for them. The rabbits love spending time in their tunnels, where they like to play and hide. This behavior is natural for rabbits and helps them feel comfortable in their environment. However, the enclosure they currently use have sharp brackets and metal parts that can be dangerous. When staff members need to clean the enclosure, check on the rabbits, or take them out for

handling, they can get scratched or cut by these sharp edges. This creates a safety risk for both the workers and the animals. Because the rabbits often hide inside the tunnels, it becomes even harder to reach them without getting hurt.



This issue usually happens during daily care routines, especially when the rabbits hide inside the tunnels and do not want to come out. It is most noticeable during cleaning, wellness checks, and when visitors want to play with the rabbits. As long as the tunnels and enclosure remain unsafe and poorly designed, this problem will continue to happen. Even though there are only two rabbits, the situation is still very important because their living space directly affects their health and behavior. The enclosure is also very large, heavy, and difficult to take apart, which makes cleaning and transportation more challenging. In addition, the rabbits can chew on parts of the enclosure, which may cause even more safety hazards over time.



This problem is very important because it affects the overall well-being, safety, and comfort of the rabbits, as well as the efficiency and workload of the staff. Sharp metal parts inside the enclosure could seriously injure the rabbits, and in really bad cases, these injuries could even be fatal. The current design also makes it harder for staff to properly maintain a clean and healthy environment. A better enclosure is needed. one that has no sharp parts, and is made from safe, durable materials. It should be lightweight, easy to take

apart, and simple to clean. The new design should also be fun and enriching for the rabbits, with enough space and tunnels for play and rest. Finally, it should include multiple access doors so staff can easily reach the animals for health checks, daily care, and visitor interactions, making the environment safer and more enjoyable for everyone involved.